SOUTH MARSTON
PARISH COUNCIL

SMPC response to S/COND/23/0848 Revised HHT Phasing Plan

3.8.2023

South Marston Parish Council wishes to comment as follows.

The major change to the sequence of development, with South Marton phases 1 and 2 now being sequential, is a great step forward in delivering appropriate phasing of housing and infrastructure provision.

Phasing Approach

Paras 1.4 and 1.5 focus respectively on the phasing approach ensuring ***'a self-sustaining form of development, avoiding further constraints being placed on subsequent phases of the development*** and ***avoiding piecemeal provision of disparate and under-utilised infrastructure***.

There is no definition of what a self-sustaining form might be, but it is clear from Reserved Matters applications already made that the need for strategic infrastructure such as SUDs and provision of foot/cycleways are being judged solely their proximity to a specific development parcel, not on the purpose that infrastructure serves. The result is a subphase 1 proposal, for instance, that has dubious effectiveness in having sufficient SUDs capacity to cope with existing surface water plus that emanating from the subphase. A further example is the proposal for 134 houses to be constructed and occupied in subphase 1 without the safe access for cyclists to Key Destinations required by the draft Strategic Design Code at 6.9.

We propose the addition at 1.6 of the Phasing Plan as follows: *Each subphase must include sufficient infrastructure for that subphase to be self-sustaining in respect of surface water management and all modes access to Key Destinations.*

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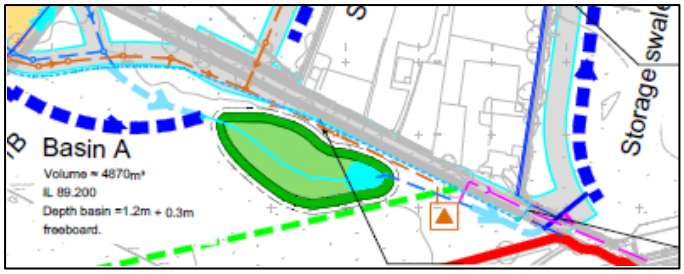
Foul Drainage and Utilities Infrastructure

Para 2.5 of the Phasing Plan requires details of the disposal of sewage for that parcel as part of the overall foul drainage strategy. We note the proximity in the Phasing Plan map of the pumping station to the main SUDs drainage 'Basin A' which receives the overwhelming majority of surface water flow from South Marston.



This is a different arrangement than that shown in the Foul Water Management Plan approved in 2022 and reproduced in the draft Brookbanks Surface Water Drainage layout plan Jan 2022 reproduced here. We hope the Phasing Plan will be corrected in line with the Foul Water Management Plan

Notwithstanding the above, we are concerned that the foul water pumping station for South Marston expansion is located very close to the planned Basin A, given the latter's importance. The same area is also close to that earmarked for use in the construction phase for the OVL/ Primary Street junction (CEMPMS plan submitted July 2022), in particular arrangement for disposal of silt etc. Para 3.1 of the CEMP states '*There will be no discharge of foul or contaminated drainage from the site into either groundwater or any surface waters, whether direct or via soakaways'.*

Whereas this is not solely an issue for the Phasing Plan, we would hope that the developers have considered the proximity in which foul water, surface water and waste from the construction site are being channelled and that appropriate safety measures will be taken.

There does not seem yet to be any strategy for site-wide provision of Utilities Infrastructure, which we hoped would be done before any Character Area Design Code is approved. We note it was not identified as a specific Reserved Matter. We believe that this Phasing Plan should confirm the timing for a comprehensive site-wide Utilities Infrastructure Plan, particularly as significant disruption to existing utilities infrastructure is anticipated.

Construction Traffic

We note:

- Para 3.17: The Primary Street will provide the construction access to support the mobilisation and delivery of the first phase of development at South Marston.
- Para 4.3: The construction access…….. will limit construction traffic through the village and separate construction and residential traffic within the site.

The word 'limit' gives no comfort, and leaves open the possibility that there may be construction traffic on village roads, for instance prior to the full length of the Haul Rd being completed. We propose that 3.17 is amended to be more definitive ie:

The Primary Street will provide the Haul Rd construction access to support the mobilisation and delivery of the first phase of development at South Marston and will be delivered West to East. No construction traffic for South Marston Phase 1 and 2 will approach development sites via any other public road route

Definitions of 'completion', 'delivered' and 'provided'

Throughout the grant conditions, items of essential infrastructure are identified showing when particular triggers are reached. These are re-stated in the tables in the Phasing Plan. Does 'providing' the SM sport pitches mean they will be ready for use at 370 dwellings and that the new SM Community Hall must be open for business at 450 dwellings? This carries implications for 3rd party involvement in supporting the design, build and eventual take-over of the infrastructure by the Parish Council, which will need significant forward planning. More importantly, can we be assured that the definition of 'completed' means that full public use of the Primary Street will be made available at 300 dwellings.

Green Infrastructure – We note that the strategic GI will be delivered and maintained by the consortium until the development is finished. As stated in our various responses to other documents, we would wish any arrangement to enable consideration of later takeover by the Parish Council.

Rowborough – We are pleased to note that the Mixed Use/Sports Hubs are to be managed separately from the other GI elements.

Contact

Clerk@southmarston.org.uk